

CBSE CLASS 12 POLITICAL SCIENCE

Top Important (IMP) Topics - Board Exams 2026

By analyzing the frequently asked questions, high-weightage questions (4 to 6 marks), and common themes across various marking schemes, here are the **Top Important (IMP) Topics** for your examination:

Part A: Contemporary World Politics

1. International Organizations & the UN

- **UN Security Council Reforms:** Criteria for new permanent and non-permanent members, and the basis of India's claim to a permanent seat (large population, economic power, etc.).
- **The European Union (EU):** The process of the EU's evolution from an economic union to an increasingly political one.
- **Relevance of the UN:** Why the UN remains relevant in a unipolar/contemporary world.

2. Environment and Natural Resources

- **The Earth Summit (Rio, 1992):** Its major outcomes, including "Agenda 21", the focus on "Sustainable Development", and the principle of "common but differentiated responsibilities".
- **Resource Geopolitics:** Control over vital natural resources like oil, often leading to neo-colonialism and conflicts such as the Gulf War.

3. Globalization

- **Dimensions and Consequences:** The political, economic, and cultural impacts (e.g., cultural homogenization) of globalization, and how it deals with the worldwide interconnectedness of flows.
- **Resistance:** Why globalization faces resistance from various political spheres.

4. South Asia and its Geopolitics

- **Democracy in the Region:** The shared aspirations for democracy across South Asian nations and the challenges faced by countries like Pakistan.
- **Regional Cooperation:** The role of SAARC and the SAFTA agreement in promoting free trade and peace.
- **India-Pakistan Relations:** Ongoing conflicts and measures to improve relations and curb tensions.

5. The End of Bipolarity & New Centers of Power

- **Soviet Disintegration:** Causes of the disintegration of the Soviet Union in 1991 and features of the Soviet economy vs. the US economy.
- **India-Russia Relations:** The cordial relationship, mutual trust, and strategic agreements post-Cold War.
- **Rise of Asian Economies:** China's economic rise, India as a new center of power, and South Korea's "Miracle on the Han River".

6. Security in the Contemporary World

- **Traditional vs. Non-Traditional Security:** Differences between the two, and new sources of threats like terrorism, human rights violations, and health epidemics.

Part B: Politics in India Since Independence

1. Nation-Building and Integration

- **Integration of Princely States:** Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel's historic role in integrating states like Hyderabad and Junagadh.
- **States Reorganization:** Purpose and establishment of the States Reorganization Commission.

2. Planning and Development

- **NITI Aayog vs. Planning Commission:** Reasons for replacing the old Planning Commission (Think Tank role, globalized era challenges).
- **Early Plans:** Objectives of the First and Second Five-Year Plans.

3. The Congress System: Dominance, Challenges, and Split

- **1967 Elections:** Known as a landmark year/political earthquake; rise of coalitions and defections.
- **The 1969 Split:** Indira Gandhi vs. the 'Syndicate', and the presidential election controversy (V.V. Giri vs. N. Sanjeeva Reddy).
- **Key Decisions:** The abolition of Privy Purses by Indira Gandhi.

4. The Crisis of Democratic Order (The Emergency)

- **Causes of 1975 Emergency:** Economic crisis, railway strikes, and the Jayaprakash Narayan-led movements.
- **Controversies & Consequences:** Curtailment of press freedom and violation of Fundamental Rights.
- **The 1977 Elections:** Formation of Janata Party and the end of Congress dominance.

5. Recent Developments in Indian Politics (Post-1989)

- **Rise of OBCs:** Implementation of Mandal Commission recommendations.
- **Major Shifts:** Era of coalitions, New Economic Policy (1991), and the Ayodhya dispute.

- **Growing Consensus:** Agreement on economic policies and the acceptance of state-level parties.

6. India's Foreign Policy

- **NAM:** India's independent stance during the Cold War.
- **Nuclear Policy:** Reasons for refusing to sign NPT and CTBT.
- **Peace Initiatives:** Decolonization support and UN peacekeeping contributions.

7. Regional Aspirations

- **Movements:** Punjab Accord (1985), Dravidian Movement, and the merger of Sikkim.

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